The Day the Crayons Quit

By Drew Daywalt

INTRODUCTION

I have a secret . . . (whispering) I still like to color! And even though my mom doesn't put my pictures on the refrigerator anymore . . . I still color. Sometimes in coloring books (which I get in my stocking for Christmas each year) and sometimes pictures I draw myself. I love crayons!!!! And you know what . . . I'm proud of it. Heck, they are even making ADULT coloring books now! I saw them at the craft store, so I know I'm not the only one. But then I got to thinking . . . what if Crayons could talk? What would they say? How do they feel? The Day the Crayons Quit by Drew Daywalt.

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NARRATOR: One day in class, Duncan went to take out his crayons and found a stack of letter with his name on them.

RED: Hey Duncan, It's me RED crayon. We need to talk. You make me work harder than any of your other crayons. All year long I wear myself out coloring fire engines, apples, strawberries and everything else that's Red. I even work on **holidays**! I have to color all the Santas at Christmas and all the hearts on Valentine's day! I need a rest! Your overworked friend, RED crayon.

PURPLE: Dear Duncan, All right, listen, I love that I'm your favorite crayon for grapes, dragons and wizards' hats, but it makes me crazy that so much of my gorgeous color goes outside the lines. If you don't start coloring inside the lines soon . . . I'm going to completely lose it. Your very neat friend, PURPLE crayon.

BEIGE: Dear Duncan, I'm tired of being called "light brown" or "dark tan" because I am neither. I am BEIGE and I am proud. I'm also tired of being second place to Mr. BROWN crayon. It's not fair that BROWN gets all the bears, ponies and puppies while the only things I get are turkey dinners (if I'm lucky) and wheat, and let's be honest – when was the last time you saw a kid excited about coloring wheat? Your BEIGE friend, BEIGE crayon.

GRAY: Duncan, GRAY crayon here. You're killing me! I know you love elephants and I know that elephants are gray, but that's a lot of space to color in all by myself. And don't even get me started on your rhinos, hippos and humpback whales. You know how tired I am after handling one of those things? Such BIG animals. . . baby penguins are gray, you know. So are very tiny rocks . . . pebbles. How about one of those once in a while to give me a break? Your very tired friend, GRAY crayon.

WHITE: Dear Duncan, You color with me, but why? Most of the time I'm the same color as the page you are using me on – WHITE. If I didn't have a black outline, you wouldn't even know I was there! I'm not even in the rainbow. I'm only used to color snow or to fill in empty space between other things, and it leaves me feeling . . . well . . . empty. We need to talk. Your empty friend, WHITE crayon.

BLACK: Hi, Duncan, I hate being used to draw the outline of things . . . things that are colored in by other colors, all of which think they're brighter than me! It's not fair when you use me to draw a nice beach ball and then fill in the colors of the ball with all the other crayons. How about a BLACK beach ball sometime? Is that too much to ask? Your friend, BLACK crayon.

GREEN: Dear Duncan, As GREEN crayon, I am writing for two reasons. One is to say that I like my work – loads of crocodiles, trees dinosaurs and frogs. I have no problems and wish to congratulate you on a very successful "coloring things GREEN" career so far. The second reason I write is for my friends, YELLOW crayon and ORANGE crayon, who are no longer speaking to each other. Both crayons feel they should be the color of the sun. Please settle this soon because they're driving the rest of us crazy! Your happy friend, GREEN crayon.

YELLOW: Dear Duncan, YELLOW crayon here I need you to tell ORANGE crayon that I am the color of the sun. I would tell him, but we are no longer speaking. And I can prove I'm the color of the sun too! Last Tuesday you used me to color in the sun on your "Happy Farm" coloring book. In case you've forgotten, it's on page 7. You can't miss me. I'm shining down brilliantly on a field of YELLOW corn! Your pal and the true color of the

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sun, YELLOW crayon.

ORANGE: Dear Duncan, I see YELLOW crayon already talked to you, the big whiner. Anyway, could you please tell Mr. Tattletale that he **IS NOT** the color of the sun? I would, but we're no longer speaking. We both know I am clearly the color of the sun because on Thursday you used me to color the sun on BOTH the "Monkey Island" and the "Meet the Zookeeper" pages in your "Day at the Zoo" coloring book. Orange you glad I'm here? Ha! Your Pal (and the real color of the sun). ORANGE crayon

BLUE: Dear Duncan, It has been great being your favorite color this past year, and the year before, and the year before that! I have really enjoyed all those oceans, lakes, rivers, raindrops, rain clouds and clear skies. But the bad news is that I am so short and stubby, I can't even see over the railing in the crayon box anymore! I need a break! Your very stubby friend, BLUE Crayon

PINK: Duncan, Okay, listen here, kid! You have not used me ONCE in the past year. It's because you think I am a girls' color, isn't it? Speaking of which, please tell your little sister I said thank you for using me to color her "Little Princess" coloring book. I think she did a fabulous job of staying inside the lines! Now, back to us. Could you please use me sometime to color the occasional pink dinosaur or monster or cowboy? Goodness knows they could use a splash of color. Your unused friend, PINK crayon

PEACH: Hey, Duncan, It's me, PEACH Crayon. Why did you peel off my paper wrapping?? Now I'm naked and too embarrassed to leave the crayon box. I don't even have any underwear! How would you like to go to school naked? I need some clothes. HELP! Your naked friend, PEACH crayon

NARRATOR: Well, poor Duncan just wanted to color . . . and of course he wanted his crayons to be happy. And that gave him an idea. *(pantomime Duncan coloring with all his crayons)*

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TRANSITION

He created a GREEN and BLUE ocean, with an ORANGE whale giving a lift to two small GRAY penguins, a PINK policeman, a BLUE crocodile and a GREEN monkey. An ORANGE sun shone down from a YELLOW sky sporting a BLACK rainbow. PURPLE and PINK dragons and a WHITE polar bear frolicked in the waves, while a RED Santa watched a PINK bus driver give a floating lift to a GREEN pig. And as for BEIGE and PEACH . . . well . . . he tried!

NARRATOR: When Duncan showed his teacher his new picture, she gave him an A for coloring . . . . and an A+ for creativity!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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